

# KAYE PUTNAM

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## SUMMARY

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Brand strategy leader with 20 years of experience building brands that drive measurable business results across recurring-revenue, B2B2C, and consumer businesses. Built the marketing function of a revenue management company from zero to \$3.7M in annual recurring revenue, stewarding a portfolio of four brands across every customer touchpoint. Created a proprietary brand strategy framework used by 100+ companies to define value propositions, positioning, and go-to-market strategy. Early leader in AI-era brand discoverability, building content systems that shape how brands surface in AI tools and searches.

## EXPERIENCE

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### Head of Marketing, Freewyld & Freewyld Foundry

*Remote / Encinitas, CA | 2024 - Present. Boutique hospitality brand and B2B revenue management consultancy (recurring-revenue model) for short-term-rental operators.*

- Steward brand strategy and consistency for a portfolio of four brands (hospitality brand, B2B consultancy, and two founder personal brands), each with documented voice systems, brand guidelines, and messaging architecture
- Built the go-to-market strategy and marketing function from zero as part of the founding team; grew to 75+ clients and \$3.7M annual recurring revenue, with \$190M+ in client revenue under management across 4,000+ listings
- Defined customer and partner value propositions and activated them across the full customer journey, from acquisition through onboarding, ongoing service, and renewal
- Pioneered AI-era brand discoverability: structured data across 25+ page types, deliberate AI-crawler policy, and a documented optimization playbook so the brand surfaces when buyers research via ChatGPT, Claude, and Perplexity
- Grew brand awareness measurably in 2026: site users up 610 percent year over year, search impressions up 4,197 percent, organic social reach up 25x, podcast downloads up 85 percent
- Built a customer storytelling engine: 20+ published client case studies with data provenance and per-client approval workflow, feeding sales enablement and brand credibility
- Run the founders' earned media program: guest placements across industry podcasts and shows, conference speaking slots (VRMA 2025 and 2026), and consumer press for the hospitality brand (Staycation TV, Visit California)
- Direct creative across web, video, social, and email; rebuilt both company websites end to end with consistent brand identity and conversion-focused architecture
- Built partner marketing (B2B2C) with industry peer Proper Insurance: co-created an industry event drawing 80-90 attendees, then grew it into an ongoing content partnership spanning a joint podcast episode, coordinated blog content, and a dedicated partner page
- Hired and lead the marketing team (video editor and marketing operations); member of the company leadership team as the organization scaled to 20 people

### CEO & Brand Strategist, Kaye & Co, LLC

*Remote | 2013 - 2024*

- Created a proprietary, psychology-driven brand strategy process used with 100+ clients across business-to-business (B2B), direct-to-consumer (DTC), eCommerce, and personal brands: positioning, value propositions, messaging, and brand identity

- Generated \$2M+ in revenue and 100,000+ leads through inbound marketing and B2B sales; sold \$1M+ in online brand strategy courses
- Built and managed a distributed creative team for 11 years: core team of 3 with project-based expansion to 15+ creative professionals and agency partners, delivering on time and within budget
- Produced a brand archetype quiz taken 250,000+ times, featured in university classrooms and business conferences
- Built omni-channel marketing strategies spanning paid social, search engine optimization (SEO), sales funnels, partnerships, and public relations (PR)
- Grew an 18,000-subscriber YouTube audience and hosted a weekly podcast on branding and psychology

### **Marketing Coordinator, 5 Star Media Group**

*Clarksville, TN | 2010 - 2012*

- Managed 50+ client advertising campaigns; planned three large-scale events generating \$40K in annual profit

### **Owner & Photographer, KAYE Photo**

*Hancock, MI | 2004 - 2010*

- Built the business from scratch; grew the client base 300 percent and profitability 400 percent through brand building and strategic pricing

Earlier roles: JP Morgan Chase, Personal Banker & Management Trainee (top 25 percent nationally) | Carlson Marketing Group (Saturn Automotive), Events & Promotions Intern

## **EDUCATION**

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Michigan Technological University - BS/BA, Business Administration (Marketing concentration, Psychology minor)

## **SKILLS**

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Brand Strategy, Brand Positioning, Value Proposition Development, Go-to-Market (GTM) Strategy, Brand Guidelines and Governance, Creative Direction, Customer Journey Activation, Customer Storytelling and Case Studies, AI-Era Brand Discoverability (AEO/GEO), Segmentation and Personas, B2B2C Partner Marketing, Earned Media and PR, Content Strategy, Marketing Analytics (GA4, Meta, Google Ads), CRM and Marketing Automation (GoHighLevel, ActiveCampaign), Adobe Creative Suite, AI Marketing Systems (Claude, ChatGPT, custom automation)

## **VOLUNTEER**

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High Point Swim Club, Race Volunteer (2021 - Present) | Greensboro Junior League (2022 - 2023) | Military Spouse Foundation, Director of Marketing (2013 - 2017)